

AN OBJECT

The paper lamp

Winter's object is the one that changes a room for the least money: a rice-paper lamp. The form descends from Isamu Noguchi's *Akari* light sculptures of the 1950s — washi paper over a bamboo ribcage — but the instinct is older, the soft glow of a shoji screen. Lit, it does not shine so much as become warm; the paper turns the bulb into something closer to the light of a fire than a fixture.

It is the perfect first purchase because it teaches the whole winter lesson in one object: that the cure for a cold room is not more light but softer light, lower down. Buy one, set it on the floor or a low table, put a warm bulb in it, and turn the overhead off for good.



Rice-paper pendant / lamp

Akari-style washi over a bamboo frame — the softest, cheapest light in the house.

\$ SHOP →